

A DATA INVESTIGATION

# Is Slashfilm Actually Obsessed With Gilligan's Island?

A few years ago, I started noticing something weird: SlashFilm kept publishing stories about Gilligan's Island. The show. The cast. The whole Gilligan Universe. So I had an AI catalogue six years of headlines to find out whether I was imagining it.

0.93% of all 21,932 stories from 2024 through Aug. 2, 2026. 68,398 headlines later: I was not imagining it.

Built from SlashFilm headlines, publication dates, and a frankly excessive amount of categorizing. August 2026 is year-to-date.

FROM 2024 THROUGH  
AUG. 2, 2026, THERE WERE

**204**  
GILLIGAN-RELATED  
STORIES

OBSERVED PATTERN  
2024-2026

# Was I Imagining This?

At first, this felt like one of those brain tricks. You notice a thing once, then suddenly it seems to be everywhere. But Gilligan stories kept showing up. Not just the island itself, either. Alan Hale Jr. Bob Denver. Natalie Schafer. The whole cast.

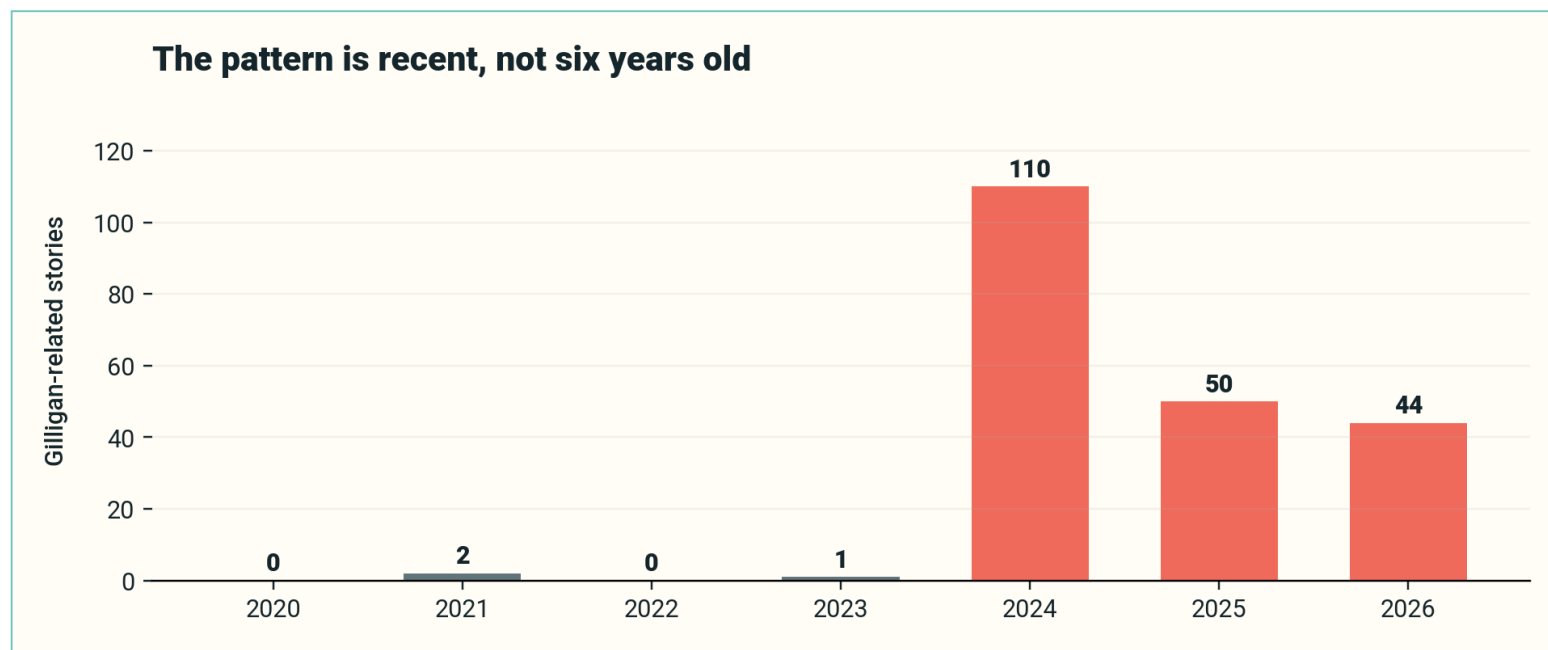
So I had an AI agent catalogue 68,398 SlashFilm stories published from 2020 through Aug. 2, 2026. I counted stories directly about Gilligan's Island, then counted the larger Gilligan Universe: the show plus its seven main cast members.

This is not a complaint that SlashFilm should cover Euphoria or Outer Banks instead. I do not have a preferred show in this fight. I just wanted to know whether a weird hunch had receipts.

For the franchise comparisons, I used the headline and URL. When a headline was vague, I checked the story quickly. The point is simple: count what SlashFilm chose to publish, then see where Gilligan lands.

|                              |                               |                                  |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>68,398</b>                | <b>21,932</b>                 | <b>2024-2026</b>                 |
| SlashFilm stories catalogued | Stories compared most closely | Where the Gilligan spike happens |

## The Gilligan Spike Is Recent

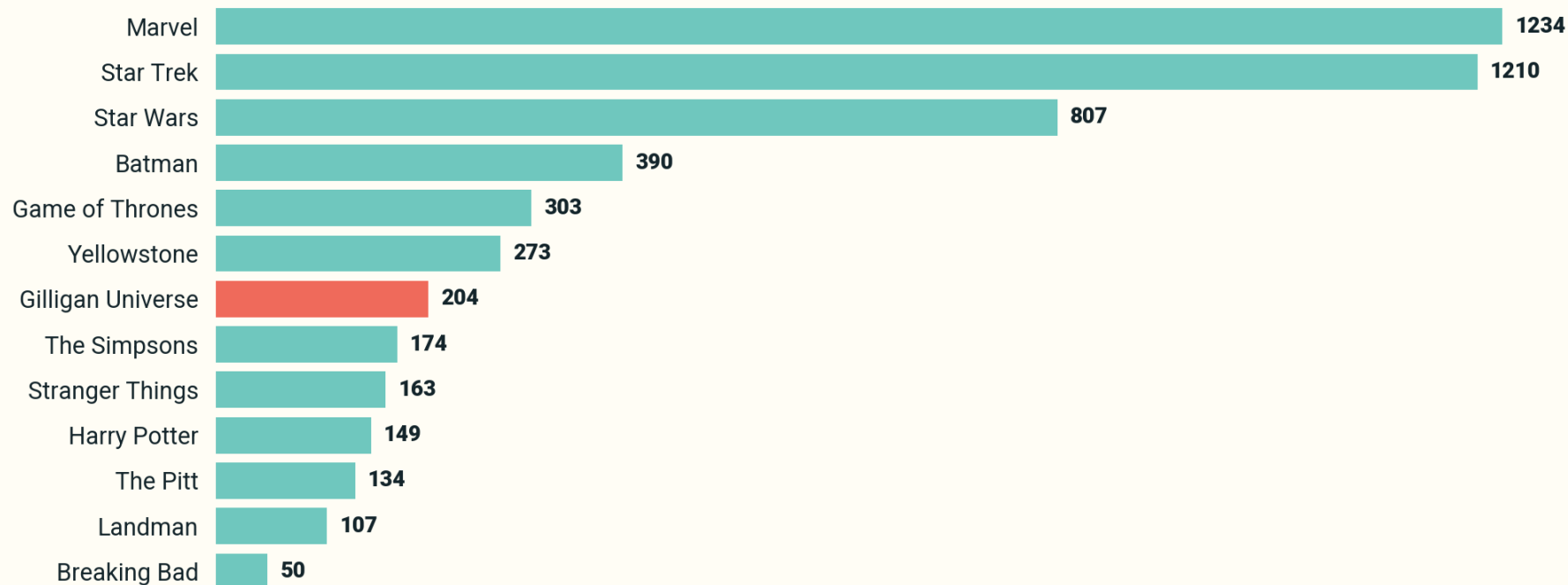


For four years, this was basically nothing. Then SlashFilm published 110 Gilligan-related stories in 2024. The number dropped in 2025, but it did not disappear. And by Aug. 2, 2026, the site had already run 44 more.

The raw annual counts: 0 (2020), 2 (2021), 0 (2022), 1 (2023), 110 (2024), 50 (2025), and 44 through Aug. 2, 2026.

## Gilligan Is Not Marvel. That Is Not the Point.

SlashFilm property mentions, 2024-2026



Marvel, Star Trek, and Star Wars are huge machines. Of course they get more coverage. The funny part is lower on the list: Gilligan Universe lands above The Simpsons, Stranger Things, Harry Potter, The Pitt, Landman, and Breaking Bad in this stretch of SlashFilm history.

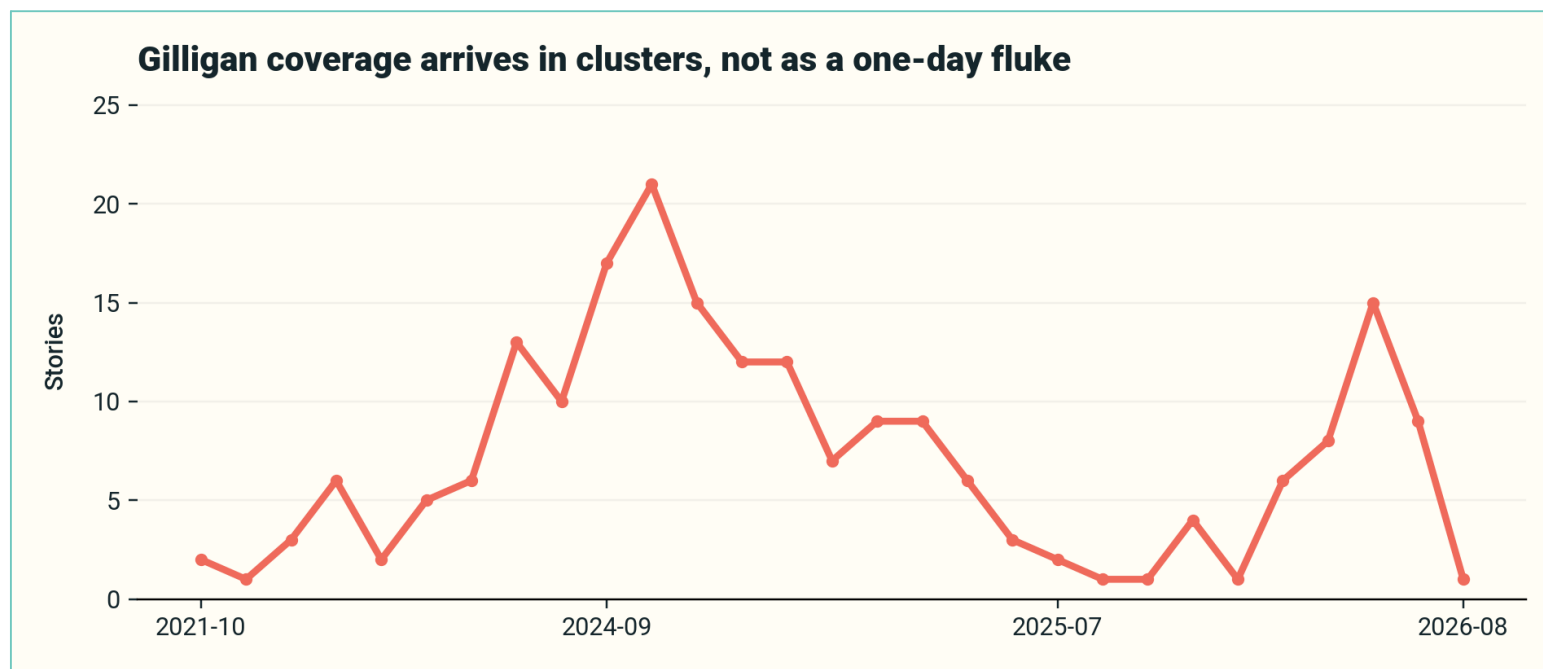
# The Island Alone, and the Island Plus Its Orbit

| Metric                     | 2024 | 2025 | 2026 YTD | Focal total |
|----------------------------|------|------|----------|-------------|
| Direct Gilligan's Island   | 66   | 28   | 11       | 105         |
| Expanded Gilligan Universe | 110  | 50   | 44       | 204         |

Here is the wrinkle: a Gilligan story is not always about Gilligan's Island. In 2026, Alan Hale Jr. is the biggest Gilligan-related subject even when the story is actually about The Love Boat, a Western, or some forgotten movie role. That is why both counts are on the page.

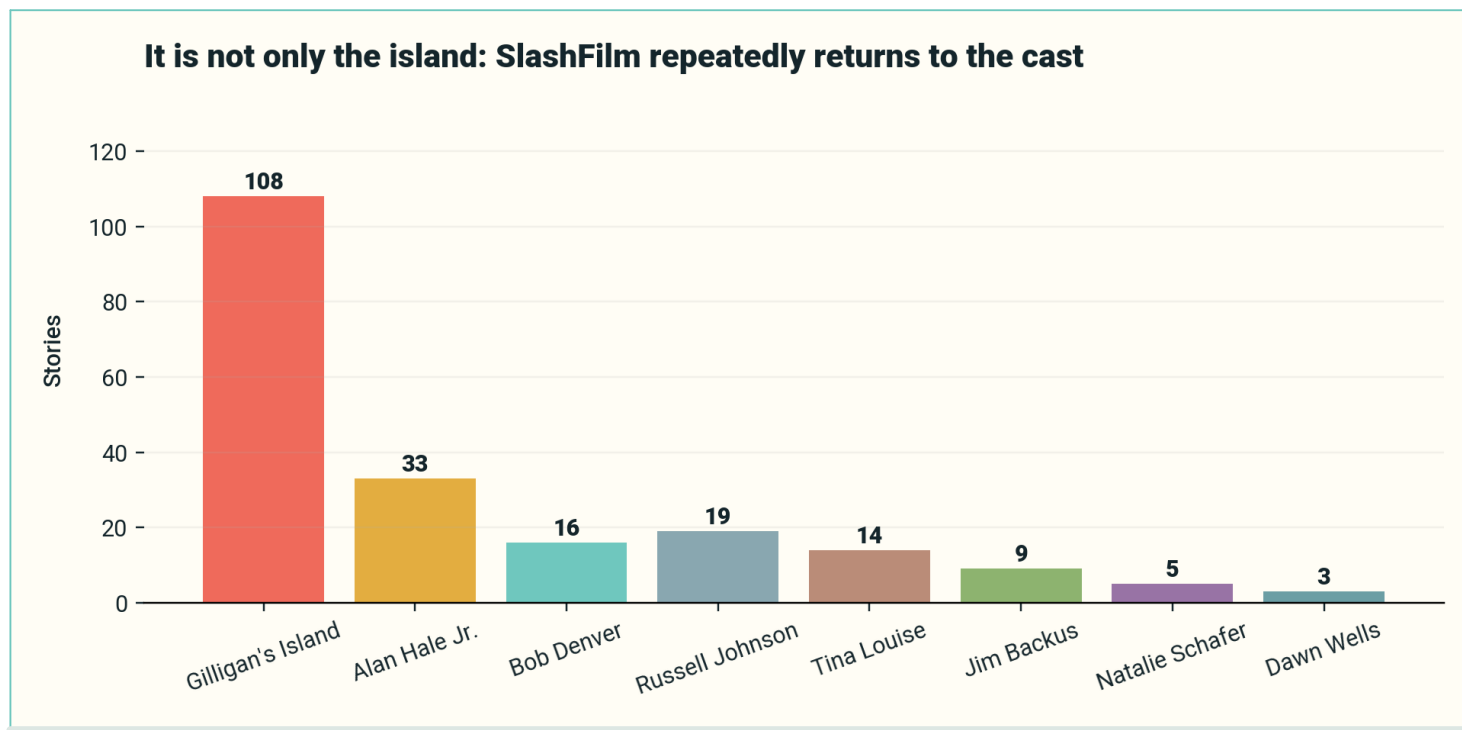
|                     |                                                |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 105                 | 99                                             |
| direct-show stories | cast-led stories added by the expanded measure |

## This Is Recurring Coverage, Not One Nostalgia Package



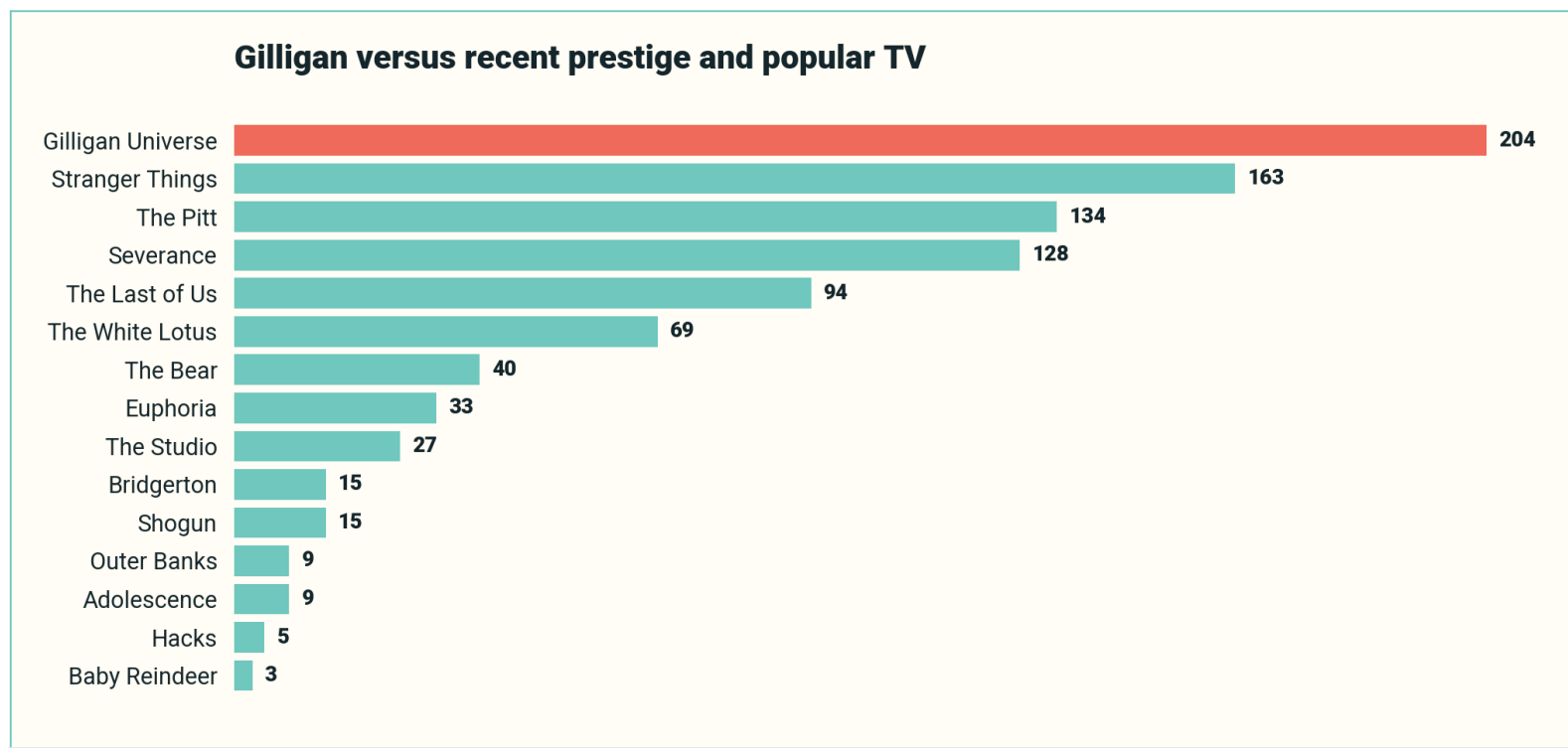
This is not one anniversary package, one reboot announcement, or one editor going through a phase for a week. Gilligan coverage keeps coming back month after month. June 2026 alone had 15 stories.

## Gilligan Is a Show, but the Cast Is the Engine



The island is the biggest bucket. But the cast is what turns it into a deep well of stories: old TV roles, behind-the-scenes trivia, forgotten movies, other sitcoms. The Gilligan Universe is doing a lot of work here.

## Where Are the Big Current Shows?



Gilligan Universe has more SlashFilm stories in this window than Stranger Things: 204 to 163. Read that again. Stranger Things is a real cultural phenomenon. Gilligan is a 1960s sitcom about seven people stuck on an island. That does not make Gilligan bigger than Stranger Things, obviously. It means SlashFilm has published a truly mind-boggling amount of Gilligan material.

The control group includes 2024 Emmy winners such as Shogun, Hacks, and Baby Reindeer, plus 2025 winners The Pitt, The Studio, and Adolescence. Popular-series controls include Euphoria, Outer Banks, Bridgerton, The Last of Us, Stranger Things, The White Lotus, Severance, and The Bear.



# So: Did You Notice a Real Pattern?

Yes, with an asterisk. Gilligan's Island is not one of SlashFilm's biggest franchises. But since 2024, the site has written about the show and its cast often enough that it belongs next to shows people are actually talking about right now.

|                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>110</div> <div>GILLIGAN-RELATED<br/>STORIES IN 2024</div> | <p>One memorable subject can stick in your head. It cannot make a site publish 110 stories in one year.</p> <p>That is the part I needed the spreadsheet to settle.</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

So yes: SlashFilm really does have a recent Gilligan thing. It is not bigger than every modern franchise. It is just bizarrely present for a 1960s sitcom and its cast, especially next to most of the current-TV group.

What I cannot tell you is why SlashFilm keeps publishing them or whether they perform well. This only answers the first question: the pattern is real.

## How to Read the Evidence

To build this, I pulled SlashFilm article pages from the site's XML sitemaps and put them into year-by-year CSVs. Each row has a title, publication time, URL, primary subject, and Gilligan-related flag. Altogether, that is 68,398 articles from 2020 through Aug. 2, 2026.

For the show and franchise comparisons, I used titles and URLs. That keeps the count focused on what a story is actually about. An article about Task does not become a story about “streaming” just because it is on HBO. And these are article counts, not every possible body-text mention.

I picked the current-TV comparison group from recent Emmy winners and nominees, plus Nielsen's annual streaming lists. Those sources helped choose the shows. The actual story counts all come from SlashFilm.

A few caveats. The older 2020-2023 rows have less complete subject labeling, so I only use them to show the big historical Gilligan swing. 2026 is a partial year. And a high article count does not prove clicks, cultural importance, or audience size. It only shows what SlashFilm published, and how often.

**The data has spoken. It brought a coconut radio.**